

» AFTER

When communist forces occupied Saigon on April 30, 1975, South Vietnamese President Duong Van Minh ordered his troops to lay down their arms.

ENFORCING REUNION

Hopes that the victors would follow a policy of political compromise proved vain. North and South Vietnam were **formally reunited** under communist government in 1976. Up to 1 million Vietnamese identified with the former Saigon regime were sent to **re-education camps** where **thousands died** of hardship and mistreatment. About 130,000 Vietnamese managed to leave the country in the last months of the war. Later, beginning in 1978, hundreds of thousands, known to the world as the **boat people**, fled Vietnam by sea. Two million people are believed to have fled by 1995.